

To selected National Spiritual Assemblies dear b ah

1992-09-03 • UHG • Weltweite Bahá'í-Gemeinde

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1992-09-03

following disturbing news just received from the bahá'í friends in iran. . . .

messrs. bihnám mítháqí and kayván khalajábádí, two active iranian

bahá'ís who were arrested three years ago and are still being held at the

gohardasht prison in karaj near Tehran, have recently been called to the

prison authorities where they were orally informed that an islamic revolu-

tionary court has issued a verdict condemning them to death.

The friends in iran had earlier reported that, as an unprecedented ges-

ture, the iranian authorities had instructed these two bahá'í prisoners to

choose muslim lawyers to defend them. presumably, this was an exercise

designed to impress mr. reynaldo galindo pohl, the Special rapporteur of

the united Nations human rights commission, who was due to visit iran

at that time. Such lawyers were eventually engaged by the bahá'ís, but, hav-

ing taken some initial steps regarding the two defendants, they found them-selves unable to continue and resigned. Therefore, the trial which resulted in the death sentences for the two bahá'ís took place without any lawyers

defending them. messrs. mítháqí and khalajábádí have appealed against

these verdicts to a higher court in iran, but the outcome is uncertain. . . .

with loving bahá'í greetings,

Department of the secretariat135.1

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Further Information on Bahá'í Prisoners in Iran

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]